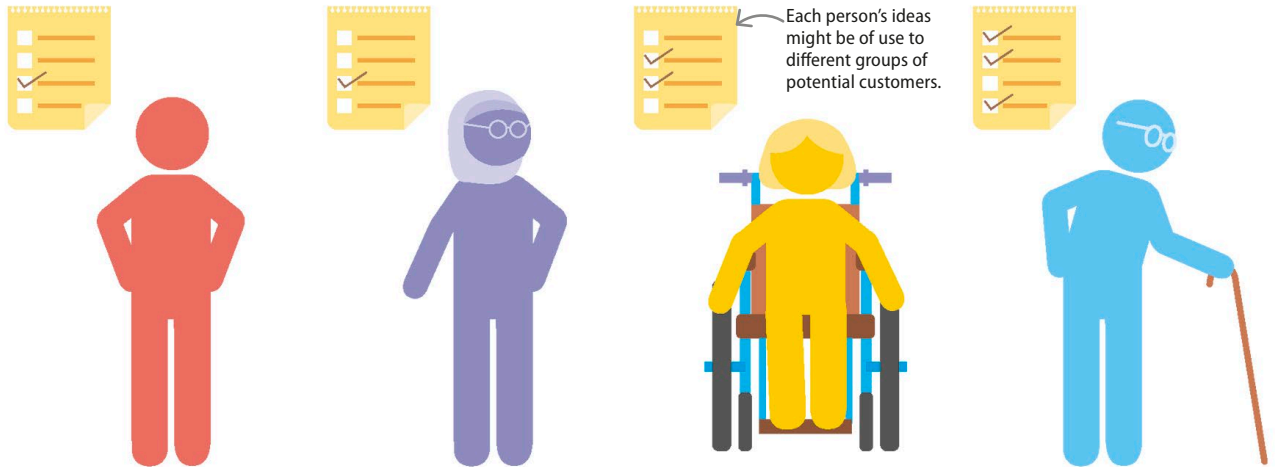


Why equality matters

Everybody has a limited understanding of the world, and especially, what the world is like for other people. Groups made up entirely of people with similar backgrounds tend to create products that will only really be of use to people from that background. By becoming more welcoming to, and inclusive of, women, minorities, and people from generally diverse backgrounds, companies can improve the ability of their products to appeal to a much wider section of users.

▽ Diversity of perspectives

Whether it's software or hardware, new products start with ideas. Including and considering many different kinds of idea helps technology work for more people.



△ Lack of role models

If young women are only aware of male computer scientists it may discourage them from considering computing as a career. Introducing them to female role models can make computer science a viable option.

△ Geek culture

The popular image of a computer scientist is a male "geek", which puts off people who don't feel they fit this stereotype. In reality, many technology careers require teamwork, creativity, and different personalities.

REAL WORLD

Transgender people

People who do not self-recognize as their birth sex are called transgender. For them, saying that they are male or female on forms is a complex and potentially troubling question. Coders are increasingly adding more choices for these kinds of question when making software. Aside from this, computer science has opened avenues for transgender people to explore and express themselves through avatars in the online world.